How to use this sheet

Travel Documents Checklist · every paper, card and confirmation, one page.

Do it a week out, not the night before

Expiring passports and missing confirmations are fixable weeks ahead and miserable at a counter. Do a 10-minute papers walk a week out, and again the night before with this sheet as the only thing you trust.

Write in the confirmation numbers

A screenshot that can't load and a confirmation number you can read aloud are different tools. Write the numbers on one sheet — it doesn't need a battery.

The carry-on rule

Documents, meds, and payment cards ride in the carry-on — the checked bag is a temporary stranger, and so is your day bag in any airport lounge. Assume things wander; pack so the important stuff never does.

Copies as backup, never as replacement

A photo of your passport in the camera roll speeds up replacing it; it never replaces it. Email copies to yourself as a second layer.

Travel Documents Checklist

One stop for every paper, card and confirmation. Pack them in your carry-on, never in a checked bag.

Everyone goes unchanged

✓	DOCUMENT	VALID FOR AT LEAST…	WHERE IT LIVES
☐	Government ID / driver's license	The whole trip	
☐	Passport	6 months past return · check now, not at the counter	
☐	Visas (if required)	Cover your full stay	
☐	Travel insurance / health card	Trip dates	
☐	Pilot's permit / boat license (if bringing toys)	Activity	

Bookings & confirmations

✓	BOOKING	CONFIRMATION #	SCREENSHOT / PRINTOUT?
☐	Flights / bus / train	_____	☐
☐	Hotels / stays, first night	_____	☐
☐	Rental car / transfers	_____	☐
☐	Tours / tickets / reservations	_____	☐
☐	Event / show tickets	_____	☐

Money & access

✓	ITEM	NOTES
☐	Two payment cards, from different providers	Carry them, not one in each day-bag sleeve
☐	Emergency cash (small notes, local currency)	
☐	One card in a phone wallet / bank app	Fallback if a wallet walks off
☐	Copy of important docs stored offline (photo mode ready)	Email the copies to yourself using no camera roll
☐	Key / house-sitter instructions left behind	See the At-Home-While-Away Checklist

The copies rule

Passports and critical IDs: ONE copy goes in the checked bag, one stays with a contact at home, and the originals never leave the carry-on. Write the copies location here: _____

Names as they appear

Ticket names need to match ID letter for letter — middle names included on passports. Fix this while booking is cheap, gone is complicated, and check-in day is worse.